

AI

DIGITAL ASSISTANT

RUNNING AGENTS

1. The first step is to identify the problem. This involves understanding the current situation and the desired outcome.

Running Agents

A Runbook for Smart Leaders

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"If I had asked people ..., they would have said ..."

— important person ...

Preface

RUNNING AGENTS: A Runbook for Smart Leaders

This book provides you with a structured approach for taming the volatile environment of digital agents. It will prepare you for avoiding the tool trap. In case you are trapped already, the book will help you escaping the tool trap.

What is this tool trap? Being addicted to tools, because the tools are cool and intimidating, is a common problem in the digital age. The more tools we use, the more we are dependent on them. The more we are dependent on them, the more we are limited in choosing our actions. The more we are limited in our actions, the more we are in danger of losing our human edge.

Withstanding the overwhelming effects of tools and processes allows us to stay clear in mind, and to be humans. Focussing on skills and our social context by choosing the right actions over using tools of our environment blindly is what makes us human leaders.

Do you feel overloaded by too many tools and SaaS applications, and do you think, it is time to utilize your time better? Here is some good news for you: The key to success is already within you.

This book will guide you through the process of adopting digital agents in a way that will enhance your leadership skills. You will learn how to leverage the power of AI agents while you strengthen your human edge.

Introduction

Why should all leaders care about AI agents?

All leaders have to deal with delegation, coordination, and communication along their daily path of actions. No matter if you are leading a group of software developers, or an ensemble of artists, no matter if you are in command of troops, or leading the learning experience in a traditional classroom setup, in all these cases you must master the three mentioned skills: delegation, coordination, and communication. Think for a moment! Do you see a demand for delegation and coordination in your daily tasks? A list of examples, where these fundamental skills are applied by leaders on a daily level is endless and easily could fill the book. Unfortunately, many people think and talk about this in a pure abstract way.

Many leaders cry loudly for better processes, in situations where better leadership could be an instant solution. Leaders can choose between skills and strict guidelines. Less guardrails require higher skills, and lower skill levels need stronger regulations. The leader should be able to increase the skill level and use existing guardrails as efficient as possible. Instead of implementing new expensive IT-processes, we can achieve a lot using smart digital skills on a personal level.

The resulting synergic effect will have the highest ROI, compared to traditional IT-projects.

Let's quickly summarize:

(1) Leaders must be able to delegate tasks, this needs effective communication, and coordination.

(2) Leaders must cope with an increasing cognitive load. This load is induced by the massive information flow, which is emerging from coordination of complex workflows in highly dynamic environments.

(3) Leaders must be able to handle the increasing amount of information that is needed for running processes and for steering them efficiently.

(4) Leadership doesn't always start with a team: leadership can and most importantly should start within your self. It can quickly turn into a group-experience.

The last point is really important. Using a new technology in your own playground, even if it is really fun, doesn't add to your leadership capability. A leader must be able to share its insights and ideas, to grow skills of others, besides inspiring and guiding them. Leadership is about detecting and proactively filling gaps around us. Digital tools and assistant systems can come to rescue and help us on a daily basis. How? This book will teach you how you can update your leadership skills.

What is RUNNING AGENTS?

This book is a practical runbook. No, not about running as a sport, but about setting yourself and your team into motion with regards to AI. The AI hype of the last years made me thinking a lot. Most likely, you and your team have your own thoughts about AI adoption - but thinking alone is not enough. Real action is needed if we want to shape our world, and our next neighbourhood, and us.

Agents should be used to support humans. They can help with automation. They can reduce your cognitive load. They can do a lot of things very fast, things which you would probably not have to do at all in a non-digital world. Mastering the digital world means, you must learn relevant digital skills and how to interact with agents. This includes selection of the right agent, customization of agents to your needs, linking them to your memories - a special subset of your personal data - and linking the agents to your environment.

We are in early 2025, a lot has been written and said about the usage

of AI systems in general, and in particular areas of our daily life.

We can't imagine being hold back from using AI in some areas, in others we use it without knowing about the fact that AI is even involved. There is such a huge buzz around AI adoption in the media. Some people are afraid of using AI explicitly, others just don't know where to start. Many people want to sell the '*silver bullet*', others rush for the fast money, but rarely do people start thinking and acting with a clear scope towards personal and team level AI adoption. Not to forget those, who sell expensive strategies, without checking your individual foundation. They can harm your organization badly!

This runbook won't teach you about how AI works internally. It is not a coder's guide to building a specific solution. But rather it is a well-tested recipe for the ambitious leader who wants to improve its digital life by a very simple approach towards conscious AI adoption.

RUNNING AGENTS is a step by step guide. It supports you in integrating AI related digital competencies - I like to call them '*smart skills*' - within your day to day work, in your private life, and within your cultural context.

Instead of providing a philosophical approach to AI-literacy, this book contributes on a practical level to your digital skill set, bringing your *smart skills* into shape.

You will learn what digital agents are, and why you need to understand the way agents work if you want to make them work for you. You will learn what agents truly need to assist you effectively.

Who should read this book?

The main audience I want to serve with RUNNING AGENTS are: *Learners, Leaders, Owners, and Makers.*

People who prefer in waiting, until someone gives them the list of

actions they are supposed to do, are not in the scope of this book. Since they act like traditional assistants, just following a script, they must switch their perspective before working with this book.

If you ask yourself: How to leverage AI agents without losing your human edge? - then this book is for you.

No matter if you are an entrepreneur, or a director of a large corporation, no matter if you are part of a public services organization, or an independent artist: if you want to master the essential digital skills of this new era, if you want adopt AI agents to your business or simply to your life, *RUNNING AGENTS* is for you.

By implementing a personal routine for using agents securely and reliably and by learning the techniques of managing information and feedback loops you will be set up for success in your digital journey.

Using agents in a meaningful way requires adoption to your very own environment, and in order to handle such an adoption you must be aware of your actual digital environment. This book will teach you methods to navigate the digital landscape. *It puts you into the driver seat!*

%=== Why am I the right person for this adventure? === What experience can I bring to your adventure? My experience in self-education, traditional studies, and effective knowledge sharing goes back into the 80s. I started with what today is called *micro learning* when I was a teenager. I continuously worked towards mastering modern technology and always looked around for opportunities of adopting the technology to solve real world problems. I realized very early in my career, that learning and organizing knowledge go hand in hand. New approaches, methodologies, and new technology always leads to additional learning demand. Nowadays, even *unlearning* of the good old stuff becomes important, to make room for fresh ideas, concepts and procedures. Remember: Only an open mind can easily adopt a new approach.

My studies in complex systems dynamics, and my life long self experimentation in the field of knowledge gathering and skill updates allowed me to dive in into the area of creation and operations of complex technical architectures and adopt to new technologies quickly. All this sounds a bit theoretical, and yes, in the first moment it really is. But soon you experience a demand of continuously learning new skills, adopting to new approaches, and if you not want to get lost, you'd better learn your way of seeing abstractions and patterns behind all the details.

One example happened in a research lab, where we have built the apparatus for doing experiments in interstellar chemistry at the University of Chemnitz, close to my hometown. A lot of abstraction and imagination is needed for that, and there was no training course which teaches researchers how to do it. If you just start doing the new undone things, and you team up with the right experts, who most likely can provide a proper environment for exercising and the exchange of ideas, you are on the right track. Anything else is a result of the reality you create with your peers. I am endlessly thankful to Prof. Dr. Gerlich, and the team around him. You all provided such an exciting learning and training environment to me.

How to follow the path, where no path exist? In this case, you become an explorer. With an explorer mindset I entered the field of enterprise data management. The adoption of '*Big Data principles*' was new and became my next challenge, my next target for a mental exploration. I decided, that I have to understand the mechanisms in global companies, especially how the company's data and knowledge is managed became the topic what had to be explored, and then to be taught to a wide range of people. Many different consulting projects gave me an environment for guiding experts, and for learning with them using the same practical micro learning approach.

My first personal insights about what *neural networks* (NN) can do for us, I could gain already in 2004 on a small computer, using C++ and Java as programming languages. It was very clear to me, this is a

great concept, the theory goes already back to the last century. But due to limitations in compute power, all we did for learning wouldn't be of a deeper practical use in the near future. The following decade gave us such a tremendous increase in compute capabilities and also many new software frameworks. The amount of available data grew exponentially, and still does. All this is like an eruption for the emerging new data landscape. Now, 20 years after I have obtained my first insights from experiments with neural networks working with them become a daily habit. It feels like having a second chance, to apply the fundamental things we learned, but for which time still had to come. Now we are in this AI era, full of digital business ideas, data, and a growing number of automated processes and agents.

Today we are able to scale existing solutions on the technical level. Just a few people are able to apply this to the human level.

This is a huge potential for the leader in all of us: bringing technology to the people and people to the technology must be done both at the same time. It is up to all of us to either participate actively, just for us, or proactively, as leader, guiding those who might not see how to participate in the socio-technical evolution.

I am more than thankful to have traveled along all those roads, and now it is time to give back. I share my personal insights and I actively support people who want to travel along with me and many others, people who are interested in shaping our digital future.

The promise of this book

In this book you learn:

- add summary of all exercises
- 1:1 mapping of insights and exercises follows.

Background and related topics

Managing AI starts with managing yourself, your data, and your goals. In this book we integrate four aspects of professional AI management:

- (1) My personal project expertise in enabling individuals, and
- (2) Cassie's Thinking and Thunking concept.
- (3) Linking your personal data to your agents and LLM workflows.
- (4) Optimizing hand-over processes in multi-team collaboration.

The main focus is on upskilling individuals. Increasing the digital awareness is so important, because, if the technology seems to be unreachable for you, it will be hard to adopt it in your life. We must become really clear about this: What are *smart skills*? Is it Math, Physics, Engineering, or non of all, but the essence of using our brain together with technology seen as a tool.

And here is where imagination and abstraction helps, ideally combined with unlearning. No, it is not needed to understand how AI systems work internally. We still can use them, as long as we know where the risks and the limitations are. Anybody can learn how to use AI and agents for personal or team support, for own benefit and for a better world.

With this book I invite you to start working on your *smart skills* today!

From Zero to One

RUNNING AGENTS provides a structured path for leaders to follow. On this path you will learn how to master new digital skills on an individual level. Later, you will be able to guide your team on the same path. This book also extends the personal approach to groups, and teams. Finally, what you have learned can be adopted by families, businesses, and organizations of any size. In essence it is simple: Start individually, make good first experiences, then manage the environment, and make it accessible to others.

Like the farmer works. The farmer does not simply scatter seeds and hope for the best. He prepares the soil — removing rocks, breaking up the hardened ground, enriching it with nutrients, and ensuring the right conditions for growth. Harvesting follows a lot of other highly related work.

Likewise, when introducing a new concept, idea, or skill — whether it's in business, technology, or personal development — the key is preparation. Just as fertile soil leads to a strong harvest, a well-prepared foundation ensures success.

You want to cultivate the smart skills? Do it like a farmer cultivates his land.

Start by:

- **Clearing obstacles** — identify and remove barriers to adoption.
- **Creating the right conditions** — ensure the environment supports growth.
- **Enriching skills** — equip yourself and your team with the right information and practical exercise.

Only then can new ideas take root, grow, and flourish.

We must be very careful and avoid the overwhelming effects of

highly complex systems on people. All too often we can hear that people complain about the underlying complexity. They argue: This is too technical for me!

Leaders must find out what those people really mean! Of course, a lot of today's things are technical. What is not technical in our world? And if something is really a natural thing, they might say: I am not the doctor nor did I study biology.

It is not about what somebody did not in the past, but rather about how somebody can handle the things of the future.

If using AI would require all of us to study Mathematics, Statistics, Physics, yes, in this case the adoption rate would be pretty low. Creators of digital products are well aware of this. Digital devices with enormous success have shown a deep impact on people and our society in many cases. Obvious examples are iPod, and iPhone, but also gaming consoles and home automation systems. But do you see all the hidden services around such very successful products, which finally lead to this intuitive experience? Without the supportive services, many of them would be not accepted by customers.

On the one hand, there is the new product, which has been created in such a way, that it solves a particular problem. On the other hand, there is the individual, who can use the device easily - even in unexpected contexts, otherwise the new offer would simply be rejected by the customers?

This is important to understand: most technical devices are very complex, and even the business models around them are complex, but nobody says: "... an iPod is too technical." No, they just use it, and the same holds for dozens of other products.

If people get *why* usage of a device is an advantage, and if using it is *straight forward*, then it will be used!

I am sure, the same holds for AI agents.

As leaders, we must put our ideas on the table, as if we bring new products to the market. We must make it easy to contribute and to follow.

From a user's perspective we must admit: Using tools and gadgets as proposed by others can be useful but also dangerous. Too much unreflected consumption of digital media has side effects on people and society. Also this is true for more or less any technical invention. There is no advancement without possible negative side effects.

Many people find themselves in an ugly situation, and not all of them are even aware of that: Either they are afraid of the side effects, or they do not know where to start using the new thing the right way. Leaders must spot such conflict and resolve it, ideally in such a way, that no additional effort is needed.

All this is also the case for AI adoption. The good news is, *we all can become the creators of our own world*. And if we are interested in taking advantage of the technological features, offered by armies of digital providers, we must start with digital awareness. We must know on which level digital services and improvements can have a positive impact on our life, and if we find such areas, we can start with practical exploration, and after some initial success, we probably are able to integrate the digital activity in our life.

Developing a strong self learning capability is supportive in today's fast changing world, if not a prerequisite.

Looking at children shows how fast they adopt the digital world, if it is presented to them as a game. The opposite can be observed in some commercial systems, e.g. buying a train ticket on a digital vending machine was pretty un-intuitive for many years - fortunately things change over time and some turn into a good result.

What is the core essence of successful intuitive systems? They are self-explanatory, consistent, and robust. Furthermore, they offer positive feedback to attract the user even more over a long time.

Is our initial attempt of implementing agents really intuitive? Was it self explanatory, consistent, and robust?

We can see how important it is to be aware of our own situation. Let's find a particular first example to get started with.

But how to start?

First, let's go through the *Zero to One* exercise together. I also suggest that you practice this exercise together with a person you know well.

It doesn't matter how deep you or the other person are involved in technology. Even if you have a person who uses advanced AI in the daily business, we want to reflect on our very own personal context.

This is because we want to be aware of the information flows which happen, when we organize our own digital life. A digital workspace in an enterprise is rarely created by the person who acts in it. A personal workspace is typically not created with digital assistance in mind. Hence, for this exercise there is no advantage for those of us, who have high-tech environments at work or at home - at least not for the first exercise. We want to get connected to the ground. This is where the foundation must be build - our starting line is not above the clouds.

We do not yet focus on extending the existing work environment. This wouldn't fit into the chapter named 'From Zero to One'. But rather we look into the foundation of a personal digital experience.

For a moment, let's assume, your partner rejects your ask for collaboration, to work with you on the exercise. The same can happen in your team, with a coworker or an employee. Instead of stopping our conversation after an initial rejection, we can turn the idea around, and start searching for a potential situation, where digital assistance, or digital support by an agent could have a benefit for him.

We can try to switch our perspective and become the digital agent, and explore the world looking through its eyes. What tools, which skills, and what information would the agent need? What is its goal? And why should a certain task be achieved at all? Such questions, answered from a different angle can allow us to step out our comfort zone. This exercise opens our mind and improves creative conversations.

In general we can say, the purpose of a digital agent is in offloading a high cognitive load from a human being. Furthermore, it can provide a much wider accessibility to information or services in the digital space much faster, with just a few clicks.

No, agents are not about replacing a human. Agents should be complementary and supportive - at least this group of agents we are talking about here in this book. Such agents can either be supportive to you directly, or indirectly because they interact in your name with others, which can save time and effort, for you and the other person. An agent can also assist you in such a way, that in a situation where you are the bottleneck, your limitation is simply eliminated because the agent acts like an amplifier or a multiplier of your given capability going beyond your capacity.

By switching our perspective or changing our role we can get a much deeper understanding of our digital buddy, our personal agent. We can feel and experience its purpose and its impact this way. If it addresses our needs, if it can remove limiting factors, or if it can expand existing capabilities, if it can leverage our work, then it is likely to become a good buddy of ours, otherwise it could be a waste of time.

In order to get ready for the first exercise, we define a bit of context. We describe three types of agents. Then, we reflect and map those agent types to real activities. This finally shows where our first agents can be implemented potentially.

Agent Types:

A: External Expert or Universal Tool

Agents of this type, give us access to things we typically could not access or experience alone, without help. Automatic translations between languages, extracting facts, and explaining complex things in simpler words are a helpful service, offered by our digital buddy. Further more, the extraction and the explanation of the '*noteworthy*' or '*potentially relevant*', instead of reading on our own, hundreds of pages can save us a lot of time.

Human expertise provided by coaches, mentors or trainers falls into the same category. In many cases, the result of an interaction with such a system or a human expert is extended access to new information which can then be processed by ourself. It is than our responsibility to use such a specific advice to change a given situation. Examples are financial advice, or prescription of an exercise or a medicine, or even trouble-shooting guides in a technical context. Taking action is on us, but our cognitive load might have been reduced by our assistants.

B: Me as a Proxy

The personal avatar, which can answer questions instead of myself is an example for the second type of agents with a direct impact on our life. We can be more present, at a much lower stress level. We can focus more on direct interactions from human to human, while all the 'mechanical stuff' can be organized in such a way, that higher demand does not directly increase my personal stress level. Using proxies allows reduction of waiting times. Proxies offer 24/7 services and even remote availability. Short: we can say that all the advantages of modern digital communication in which we meet as humans directly in a meeting room in a synchronous way can be brought to the next level by using proxies and avatars, which

represent our self.

For sure, not all topics and aspects can be covered to the extend of 100% by our digital buddy. But we all know the 80/20 rule. Just by virtually being present 24/7 while solving a subset of the problems which occur in absence, we would have to handle otherwise could be a huge win.

But wait! This phrasing is dangerous, it expects from our buddy, that it is capable of problem solving. Skeptical people couldn't be convinced this way. We need a slight mindset shift. Let's rephrase the idea: *Just by virtually being present 24/7 and by answering a subset of the questions, we would have avoided a lot of problems, which otherwise could appear. This is a huge win!*

In general, agent type **A** and type **B** are very comparable in the way they work internally, but they are different with regard to the purpose and expectations. An agent of type **A** will be used to serve our demand for external advice. An agent of type **B** will be used for serving others.

Next, in order to find our agent candidates, we want to prepare our mindset to envision situations where agents can be an improvement of our life.

We want to avoid repeating the question: Where in your life can I apply this or that gadget? - after brainlessly buying and regretting it. My goal is to enable you to rethink your situation, identify a gap, and finally tell others, what kind of problem your assistant or agent should solve for you. With this, you can shape the criteria for measuring success and this way you are in control of your digital life.

Otherwise, all you do is using a tool, in the worst case getting addicted to it, or just complaining if it does not really satisfies you. Let's create our own experience.

Let's go on to agent type **C**.

C: Extension of Myself for Myself

This type of agents can take the results provided by agent type **A** or prepare the input needed by type **B** for delivery to an external participant, who requests something from us.

This is the place where either, I can get under pressure by too much input from **A** or too high demand via **B**. In order to participate in a stable digital interaction all three agent types must be in balance. Most importantly, all three must support each other without overloading ourselves.

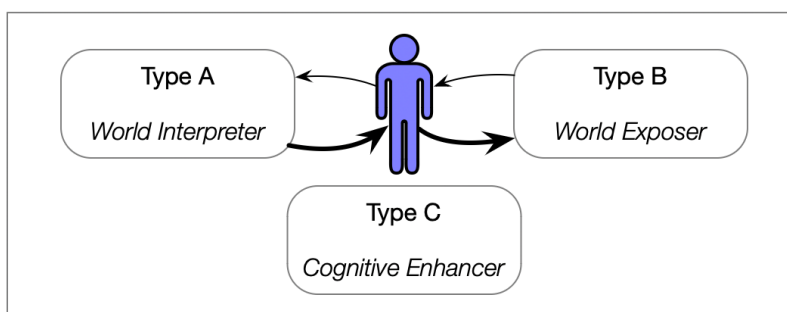


Fig. 1 - How Information flows through me via agent support

These three agent types form an essential communication pattern. Once agents are added to your personal information flows and to your communication landscape, maintaining this balance becomes an important task of your daily routine. In figure 2, the gray circle around the human is the scope of its personal life, or a personal role in an organization. The gray boxes represent the specific agent types, used to interact with the world, organizations (on abstract level) or other people (in personal level).

Now it is time to identify a first example, of using a digital agent.

Know your Agents

To know all the existing agents in your life, you should start identifying them. Finding and recognizing them is the first step in the process of adopting agents to your life style. The following exercise will help you to identify the agents you already use, and to envision new agents which could be helpful for you, your team, and your organization. Those agents have the highest potential and probably the highest impact and go far beyond pure excitement and entertainment.

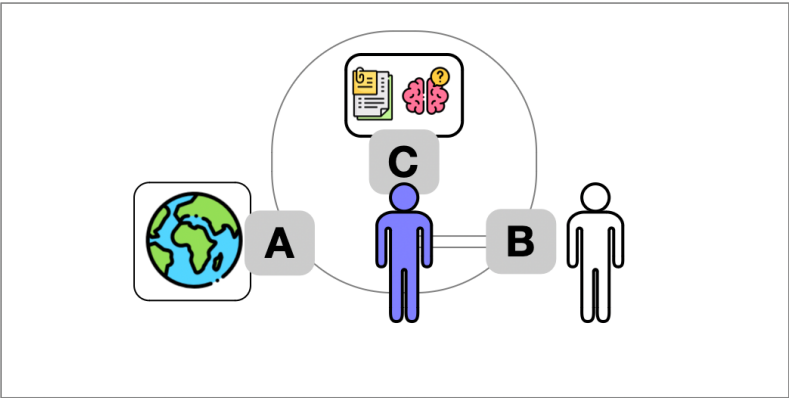


Fig. 2 - How agents connect me better to the world, to others, and to myself

Exercise 1

Investigate your daily routine, your typical work tasks, or the tasks you like to do as part of your hobby. Identify tasks where a digital system, a device or a tool is already used, or potentially could be used. Do you wish, you could save time in some situations? Do you fear the overwhelming effect of some tasks you are expected to do? What if an agent could assist you and take away the pressure?

The following table shows some examples.

Type	Task	Tool / Mode
A	Translate Emails from English to German language	DictionaryChatGPT / manual task
B	Summarize and answer a recorded call with an automatic response	Call Center Agent / automatic
C	Review my personal notes and compile a todo list, which is automatically send to my mailbox on Friday afternoon, for review and preparation of the next week.	personal buddy / automatic

It is very likely, that you already actively use agents, without knowing it. Maybe you will be surprised when you realize the fact, that you actively use digital agents already - probably they are out of your control. No problem. Many services and devices are provided and operated by others to serve us. Not much has to be changed in this space for now, but as soon as we become aware of such dependencies, we can proactively decide where to go deeper and/or where to stop, when and why.

Please go over your table again, and add labels to track how you feel doing these tasks.

Exercise 2:

Please talk to a friend, family member, or someone in your team, and find situations where you interact with each other. Find out if a proxy (agent type **B**) could or should be introduced, for whom?

Do you find a situation where an agent of type **C** would like to interact with your partner's proxy, agent **B**? Please note what it could mean

for your personal participation in (a) the communication channel, and (b) in the overall process. Could the agents reduce the amount of time you are actively communicating, but give you back free time for real conversations and problem solving tasks?

Summary: 3-Personal-Agents Model

This model defines three agent types:

- A - World Interpreter: Bridges the real world to me, making it accessible regardless of language or format of the information.
- B - World Exposer: Represents me externally, interacting with the requests to me on my behalf.
- C - Cognitive Enhancer: Works directly for me, augmenting my thinking and decision-making.

Together, these agents form an personal digital assistant ecosystem that connects, represents, and enhances a person's human capability in the digital world.

As much as you probably know at any time, where your smartphone is, or where you find your preferred pen, and how to use both of them, you should be able to name and to identify your agents, your digital tools. Tools will most likely turn into agents soon.

If you link this knowledge to all the obligations or expectations towards you and then find assistants by using the 3 agent types as described in our first exercise, you will be well equipped to master your digital future.

You start growing your digital *smart skills*.

Let's build a really strong foundation for your adoption of digital agents: Start becoming aware of the digital agents you already use, and find out which could probably be used soon. Collecting and

classifying agent ideas can become a regular exercise for the next weeks. Look around, and identify helpful agents, which can be used also in your daily life. This is the first step to become a digital leader.

Part 1: A Personal Digital Experience

When I asked experts and leaders about their experience with AI agents, they often started talking about others, why - in their own opinion - they failed or why they think others shouldn't use them. They tell you why AI can't work in this or in that case. Only in very rare cases, they proudly present a specific personal experience with AI on a personal level.

AI is present, for sure it will stay, but we as a society and also people are not yet connected to it.

This indicates that there are two types of thoughts: one group is focused on others, on regulation, and the other group speaks about their own experiences, ambitions, and motivation.

Regulation is important. You have a lot to loose, if you don't know and follow the rules. But since experiences can come only from inside, we will focus on the second type of thoughts around AI and its integration in a personal digital experience in this chapter. Adopting the rules is way easier once you know what they are about. Otherwise, they can drive fear and rejection more than they help us.

My personal observation from interviewing dozens of leaders is that successful people share a common trait: when they talk to you, they share personal experiences. This happens in various situations — whether it's about handling challenges, managing technical issues, or improving their own skills. Being in the driver's seat, actively engaging with their experiences, seems to be a key factor for their success.

Most of the people I talked with do not have a strong opinion on using AI for their own regular tasks, nor do they share ideas about using the technology in a collaborative setup. This chapter and the next will cover both aspects:

(A) The personal experience with AI agents, and

(B) The group dynamics of working with AI agents.

When I look back and start thinking about what I would have recommended to leaders, who want to start using AI, I can see clearly, how the potential advice has changed over the years. The market is highly volatile, things you start today can be obsolete in the next quarter. Looking into my own company, the engineering team I lead, and into dozens of customer projects I delivered as examples gives me valuable first-hand insights.

Never before, since I have worked in the digital domain, have I seen such a high change rate. AI model architectures, agent frameworks, fully managed cloud services, and data stores for serving context and training data to AI systems emerge rapidly.

For leaders, who plan to adopt agent supported procedures, something else matters more: How do people interact with agents and how do they share thoughts and documents with the new technology stack?

Hence I sharpened my focus: I started looking carefully into the human machine interaction sector. This is the area where humans interact with technology and information as individuals or as groups. The human machine interface is a well known element, but it falls to short in today's scenarios. Why? Because it does not capture the collaborative aspects and also synergy effects of working with AI agents. Those are critical and not yet covered by the 1:1 interaction of a person and a machine.

Can agents bring success?

Success, for me, is not about what others think I should or shouldn't do. It is about my ability to recognize and take the right actions, guided from within me. What brings me closer to a fulfilled life can be part of my success story. This, of course, includes seeking support from other people, and leveraging technical systems, such as AI

agents. Success is not about doing everything alone, but about taking ownership of the ideas and actions we engage with on our path towards success, towards a meaningful life.

When working with AI agents and establishing personal experience, one key insight becomes clear: true understanding comes only from hands-on engagement with the tools at your disposal.

Regular and consistent use of AI agents deepens your connection with the technology, laying the groundwork for meaningful, experience-based learning. Interacting with a personal digital agent, for example, allows you to see its capabilities firsthand—whether it’s transcribing spoken notes into text or attempting to interpret handwritten input. At times, these processes will function smoothly; at others, the agent may misinterpret or struggle to process the information accurately.

Such imperfections are part of reality. No system is flawless, and expecting perfection from the outset is unrealistic. AI agents need to adapt, and so do we as users. Errors and missteps are not just obstacles but integral to the learning process—for both AI and humans. Over time, successful collaboration depends on mutual learning and adjustment.

Expertise and Experience

Looking back on my own digital journey, I can see how my expertise has grown over time. How did that happen? I rarely took formal courses — most of the digital *smart skills* I’ve learned come from hands-on experience. It’s been a cycle of experimenting with new ideas, encountering failures, refining approaches, trying again, and repeating the process until something worked. As the Nike ads say, *Just do it!* — so I did.

I started with a strong focus on technical fundamentals: craftsmanship of working with materials such as wood and metal, followed by fixing and designing electronics, simple hardware setups,

basic networking. Software development, and data management have been put into the focus after some years of experience. Over time, my skill set expanded to include analytics, statistics, and machine learning. As I gained more experience, I incorporated architectural expertise (systems architecture, not construction of buildings), shaped by real-world solutions developed with and for my customers. This is just one example of how a career path can be shaped by real world influences. This lead to deep insights and hands on expertise. Now it is time to link all these experiences to the emerging field of AI agents, and to share it.

Current AI solutions can process vast amounts of data far faster than we can read and analyze it. They can identify patterns with greater speed and precision than humans. However, unless an AI system encounters text that provides an interpretation of facts — one that aligns with a recognizable pattern — it cannot truly apply its own experience and do interpretations on itself.

For AI to develop something akin to personal expertise, it would need to learn through direct experience, adapting and evolving as it interacts with the world. Only then could we potentially reach the stage of self-aware smart agents. As of today, to the best of my knowledge, no AI system has achieved this level of self-awareness or independently maintained expertise.

The shifts and adoption of new challenges throughout my career have allowed me to explore new opportunities and develop a deeper understanding of the digital landscape.

A pre-programmed expert would simply follow a predefined path, regardless of how the environment changes—just like many of our machines. They function well until conditions shift. When that happens, they either fail or stop, despite any insights they might gain from data. In general, they cannot adapt to new situations.

The same applies to today's AI systems. They have been trained on past data and can continue learning, but learning is not yet an

inherent, ongoing process for them. Chatbots may attempt to memorize information to refine their responses, but they do not follow self learning principles. That remains a distinctly human ability. We can design learning paths for ourselves and others, facilitate learning, and gain knowledge from those around us. Learning is both a human and a social activity—one that fundamentally distinguishes us from machines, no matter how many transistors they carry.

I would say: yes, AI agents can become success factors, if used the right way. But they are not a delivery service for success. It is still on you to be successful!

The Power of Reflection in Learning and Growth

To get started, you should look into a particular skill you regularly apply or practice. Since you already have the skill, you are qualified to oversee the quality of the outcome. You might be able to identify what went wrong and what needs to be adjusted. Different situations exist during training. You might already see whether an outcome matches the expectation or not, but you may not yet know why the difference exists. Because of this, it is important to develop a sense for exploring the root cause of such differences. Even more important is to spot the difference between given and expected results.

Even if I, as a leader, do not know how to achieve a particular result, I can contribute by sharpening my senses to figure out what would have been needed. Practically, this means being clear about acceptance criteria, even if the path to success is not perfectly defined yet. Exploration and learning go hand in hand. This type of learning is very different from an authoritative learning path, which assumes the right way to solve a problem is already known. In many cases, alternatives are not wanted unless explicit change has been requested. That would be an intentional switch into an explorative learning path.

Reflection on your recorded tasks must be adapted to the existing context in which you are working or learning. It is crucial to be aware of the level of your reflection. Are you reviewing how you explore the path toward a new solution? Or are you reviewing the outcome of an activity already learned? Both reflections are important and must be applied regularly, but be careful not to mix discussions about them. As a leader, it is your responsibility to understand this difference and support your team in conducting review sessions effectively.

Since none of us want to be blocked in our thinking, preparing for discussions is always a great way to improve reflection. Since this chapter focuses on personal digital experience, we should ask: How can an AI agent help improve my reflection practice?

Balancing Personal Development with AI Assistance

I suggest doing weekly reflections on three levels. The first two are defined by their nature, but there is another important level—one that is crucial for both leaders and individuals. Our goal is to improve self-learning capabilities, becoming adaptive and fast in learning things that truly matter to us. This means focusing on tasks and topics that contribute predominantly to our own work, our own life, and what we believe is important.

Yes, this may sound strange to many people. The majority is trained to be ready for others. But serving others does not mean you should ignore yourself. A strong servant provides better service. To be effective, you must first strengthen your own capabilities before applying your skills to serve others. With this in mind, training, improving, and enhancing skills are critical — especially in a service oriented environment.

If you are constantly dealing with things that do not matter to you but are only for the success of others, you will become exhausted sooner than later. You will feel empty. You won't be able to grow—not in your mindset and not in your skills. While it is true that most of today's

workforce provides time and skills for the success of others in exchange for money, this should be seen as a starting point for improvement, not as an endpoint.

For me, improvement happens as soon as I can shift my focus, adjust priorities, and increase contributions to my personal success criteria. AI agents can play a crucial role here. The amount of time I need to be physically present in a service setup can dramatically change if I create a valuable avatar — a digital clone of myself handling 70–80% of requests around the clock. Until now, my service has been bound to regular office hours, tied to a particular time zone. With my personal avatar, I could overcome this limitation, remaining available anytime while focusing more intensely on the 20–30% of work that truly requires my expertise and presence.

Journaling as a Bridge to Your Personal AI Agent

Instead of relying solely on material provided by others — consuming digital goods all day long — I suggest establishing strong digital journaling expertise. The habit of writing has an enormous positive impact on the human brain. Many authors and coaches recommend daily journaling for mental health. Regular reviews and monthly journaling practices are considered practical management advice. Now, let's combine both and bring them into the digital world.

When I started journaling, I enjoyed capturing my ideas. It allowed me to envision things ahead, clear mental roadblocks, and deeply experience the benefits of structured thought. Writing became a skill in itself. Regularly thinking and writing, even without a specific goal, acted as a form of mental massage—leading to greater awareness and flexibility. Ideas resonated faster. My subconscious seemed more prepared to accept new insights that I might have otherwise missed.

Now, let's connect this with AI. Imagine a digital agent helping us identify patterns in vast amounts of documents, conducting research, and surfacing relevant insights without the time constraints of

human effort. Isn't this similar to how our unconscious mind works—processing information in the background until a spark of creativity appears?

For every leader or expert looking to integrate AI agents, I propose starting with a *Personal Digital Business Journal*. This is not a replacement for existing tracking and journaling tools, but rather a complementary approach designed to build a bridge between you and your personal AI agent.

Enhancing Creativity and Automation Through AI

AI agents help reduce cognitive load by handling repetitive tasks, processing unmanageable volumes of data, and automating workflows. However, distinguishing between automation and real AI assistance is essential. Many digital workflows are simply automated steps, not true agents. They do not “think”—they execute predefined instructions. True AI assistance comes when an agent interacts dynamically, learns from context, and adapts to new situations.

Incorporating AI into your personal business journal creates an opportunity to identify gaps in skills and information. It allows you to reflect on work quality, and to explore automation potential from your point of view. By tracking your activities and thoughts, an AI agent can suggest improvements, propose learning exercises, and create a structured learning path tailored to your needs. Instead of pushing you into generic training courses, it can guide you step by step, adapting to your pace and personal context.

Business logs also provide valuable insights into automation opportunities. Repetitive tasks, high-frequency activities. Bottlenecks in workflows often signal where AI can step in. Many things we assume cannot be automated should be revisited—technology has advanced significantly, making automation more accessible and cost-effective than ever before.

Retaining Human Control in an AI-Augmented World

A personal AI agent, starting as a business journal tool, has the potential to deeply integrate with your digital world, offering insights, structuring thoughts, and enhancing productivity. However, we must remember — we remain in control. Our goal is not to hand over our lives to AI but rather to create a robust, reliable connection between our mental state and the digital agents around us.

We do not need to give up our human nature to compete with AI. Instead, we use AI as a tool that represents us in the digital world, assists in what we want to achieve, and amplifies our capabilities. We sit in the driver's seat—AI is our driver assistant, making the ride smoother, faster, and more secure.

Where do I loose time?

Is it just me? Am I the only one who loses time all day long? Obviously not. Many people suffer from time shortage. Some of us claim to master their time highly efficiently thanks to the great tools they claim to use and try to sell to you. And now, with more and more digital agents entering the market, many experts claim that all could become even better. But what does it mean? They promise you to save a lot of time. They promise perfect time utilization for more and more success. But let's stop for a moment. Timing alone isn't the real issue.

This book also does not offer you an ordinary time management exercise. Besides using our time efficiently, we must make sure that we focus on the right things, which means focusing on the things that really matter. This includes prioritization and steering of our attention. Both are not possible without our own reflection. How would you know about your priorities without proper reflection, and without having your vision, your personal goals in mind?

Before we look into the details of saving time by extending our capability or automating recurring activities, we must prepare our

journey. We must stay on track or even adjust our desired route according to changing situations, and this must become a routine, a habit. This must be something where our digital experience allows us to utilize external support and combine it with our innermost routines.

I follow a distinct approach. Still, I think losing time is a valid aspect of life which must be considered in our daily activities. But time optimization and avoiding losing time make sense only if the right context is taken into account. What is the right context? It should be based on your personal experience, your personal desire, and your personal demand.

Like any digital experience, the idea of optimizing time usage should be driven from within you. It must be aligned with your goals. Time management should never be dictated on top of you or over you, but rather it must be something that emerges from you.

Using digital agents can allow us to decouple heavily from external time pressure. Typically, the external time pressure is a result of time-based optimization of processes we are a part of. And here's the problem: too many interactions between our world and us need a certain synchronization, and in many cases, you can't control the moment when others are demanding you, and the times you are under control of your schedule.

Withdrawing from all these interactions doesn't seem like a good solution. I suggest starting with building and increased awareness, and also establishing clear measures which help you to drive your actions into the direction you want to go. Using digital assistance or smart agents can be the right thing for you. So, we no longer think about automating processes in the first moment, but rather aim at understanding the processes. We want to understand the type of interactions and needed synchronizations. Based on this, we can focus on important elements of management: we can work on better synchronization, on avoiding blockers, and in general, we should focus on decoupling, which is done by removing dependencies.

A lot of improvements can already be achieved without digital agents by using solid daily, weekly, and monthly routines. Traditionally, such established routines are not very dynamic. Once in place, they seem to work great, but small disturbances can bring such routines, which heavily depend on the synchronization with others, to a stop or even break.

As a consequence, I suggest establishing proxies for easy decoupling of subsystems, and this means in particular adding a personal agent to your role in business, for example, helps you to be available for others even if you aren't available physically.

In the beginning, this may sound strange. Many people are afraid of losing control. And this is where my approach starts: it puts you into the driver's seat of your digital journey. It gives you the digital tool belt with the necessary tools and practices so that you will master your agents, and this opens the door for you and your agent to participate in an *agentic working environment*.

As shown in the previous chapter, there are different types of agents. Mastering all three of them together brings you advantages in your business.

Removing Time Drains

Let's define the goal of our exercise. We want to identify and reduce time drains from our schedule. First of all, within your personal context, be it private or professional — intentionally, we start ignoring others around us — let's just use our own memories, perception, and observations in our regular reflection routine. Start collecting information about interactions with others. This way, you gather process metadata quickly. This is essential for understanding and improving the workflows you are involved in.

You should start with becoming aware of where your valuable time gets lost. You lose time due to unnecessary interruptions, waiting

times due to bad preparation, redundant work due to miscommunication. The list is very long, so we'll stop here.

Some of the issues are purely under your control, but only if you are aware of them. Establishing awareness is obviously the first step towards optimization. And when it comes to interactions with others, you probably have never thought about a real investigation of your daily routines. Your experience is a consequence of all external interactions reaching you and your capability to handle and control your own time and attention budget. How you deal with those influences is in your hands, if you want it to be.

With a simple tracking and review exercise, you build the foundation for adding a digital agent to your life. There is a clear purpose for doing so; the agent should be beneficial to you primarily. This will be the case if it takes away a heavy load from you and also if it makes you more available to others.

Hence, we track our time and mark individual blocks of time spent during the day on particular tasks with classification labels such as high-value and low-value time. High-value time is the time you spend in line with your expectations. Low-value time is the time which feels like lost time. Reflecting on the quality of time for particular actions gives an indication regarding options for adding digital agents to assist you.

Low-value time could be changed into high-value time by asking yourself why it was of low value. If you figure out that you lost time because the communication was not clear and relevant preparation for a given task had not been done when needed, you could use an automatic prerequisite checker task, and later you can delegate this task to your agent, which then proactively can help you to avoid such low-value time slots.

If the low-value time is the consequence of unexpected interruptions by others, you probably could have avoided this by using your digital avatar agent acting as a proxy of yourself.

In case the low-value time comes from a mismatch of expected skills and available skills, you have a strong indication of a training or upskilling demand. And now you have the choice to start adjusting your skill profile or even to delegate the task to the right person who has that profile already.

The essence of this exercise is that you become aware of the quality of your time spent on tasks. You have found typical potential for adding digital agents to your life, and most importantly, you start focusing on the tasks which matter to you, and you align those tasks better to your real situation. With our practical approach, we can easily identify the low-value tasks and also long-running tasks in our daily routine, and if we could just kick some blockers out of our path, we instantly would feel better. Every day a little bit.

This is already a very clear path towards digital agents. You may ask: How could I do this kind of tracking and reflection efficiently? The digital *Business Journal* agent has been built exactly for this purpose.

Tracking the time spent and the time usage quality numbers in order to assist you in your personal style of doing things can also be called self-reflection assistance. Initially, it improves your awareness, and in the future, it will also become more important and relevant on the content level, but for the beginning, it's just fine to have a digital buddy who allows us to get access to our own processes metadata. More awareness allows better decisions, decisions actively done by you!

Journaling, as a digital routine

The goal of this exercise is to create a sustainable and beneficial digital journaling routine that enhances self-reflection, improves awareness, and opens the door for future AI assistance to support your personal and professional growth.

Exercise 3: Establishing a Digital Journaling Routine

Step 1: Find Your Rhythm

Your journaling routine should match your natural rhythm and preferences. Some people prefer writing in the morning to set intentions for the day, while others find value in evening reflections. Decide:

- Will you journal daily, weekly, or at a different frequency?
- Will you do it at a fixed time or as needed?

Action: Use our self reflection app **maind.REC**. It helps you to experiment with your personal note taking practice at different times and frequencies over the next week. Please identify what works best for you.

Step 2: Establish Continuity and Accessibility

To make journaling an effective habit, it must be easily accessible. For build a digital memory, which can be shared with agents, I recommend to use our maind.REC application and to push relevant documents, fotos, recordings into your personal digital memory on a regular basis. It is not another system for organizing documents, no, it is all about capturing the information, not yet contained by the documents you already deal with.

In a future phase of agent adoption, we will cover the details of personal document management, but for now, this would be to much of a distraction.

Action: Use the **maind.REC** application regularly, This is a simple, low-friction system for recording your thoughts. It uses an embedded AI agent, tracks workflows and assists you in capturing and revisiting memorable entries.

Step 3: Focus on Reflection and Awareness

Journaling is most powerful when it brings clarity to your thoughts and decisions.

- Record key events, decisions, and emotions tied to your work and life.
- Identify blockers and time drains from your day.
- Note any unusual observation or recurring challenges.

Action: At the end of each week, you will receive an email to review your entries. It is very easy: you simply add labels to particular entries. This first iteration on your data helps you to see the world in a different light, and your agent starts learning patterns in time usage, efficiency, and emotional state.

Where to go from here?

A personal AI agent can enhance your journaling by:

- Structuring notes and surfacing insights.
- Helping recall past entries relevant to a current challenge.
- Linking items together, even if they seem to be unrelated at a first glance.
- Automating summaries and trend analysis.

Later we will integrate more agent support into your journaling process by allowing the agent to categorize, analyze, and prompt deeper reflection based on past entries.

In the beginning, journaling is a personal practice. Beyond that, AI enables a new way of working and thinking. Intentionally using a collaborative memory where insights can be shared while maintaining individual autonomy on actions will be shown in part

two of this book. Already now, I suggest you think about:

- What elements of your journal could be useful for collaboration?
- How might AI help you selectively share insights while keeping personal reflections private?

As a leader it is on you, to initiate and coordinate the AI-supported shared memory spaces of your team. It is likely not your team, which creates such an environment alone. Alone information security and compliance aspects are blocking this new approach towards smart team collaboration. But with a proper data security strategy and the right tools on your belt, you can make this reality happen. I suggest to start with a small experiment. It helps your team, to practice and validate such collaborative projects. Starting with a collective journaling experience you can quickly enhance decision-making and problem-solving procedures. People will feel more involved, and acceptance of the new methods can grow.

Before we go into the group dynamics of working with agents in the next chapter, we will look into the journal you just have created, and start using it to our advantage.

Digital Flows: Input, Processing, Output

We want to prepare the next exercise. It can be done in two ways. Option one: you use a spreadsheet and track the information about your tasks and interactions with others on a daily basis for one week - just use the template from our website. Alternatively, continue directly with your digital assistant and the **maind.REC** application. Simply speak to your assistant, track your thoughts about tasks during the day, describe issues and observations, and use our tagging system to mark your memories. Tag highly productive time enjoyed as "high value", and track negative experiences by tagging them as "low value". This will become an indicator for items we look deeper into later on.

Our digital reflection assistant collects the information you share daily. It provides initial insights in its weekly report. This way, tracking your memory and impressions should be as easy as possible. We have built a smooth assistant which allows integration into your daily flow with the lowest possible risk of interruption. We decided to start the digital agent journey with a very simple recording app which collects items for your long-term memory. There is a direct link between the memory you create and fill up and the memory your agent will use and learn from. There is no additional document management or complex ticket tracking and time tracking system involved - just simple daily notes, taken by you and automatically processed by your digital buddy.

This way you provide your agent and yourself access to your life's metadata. This data is important for you because it is part of your reality, and you should build your reflection practice on top of that information. Asking yourself once a month about things that worked well and didn't work so well doesn't work because you simply lose too many things. Actively writing and rethinking every day and working on the procedures every day is also not a good idea because now you would constantly focus your attention to this meta-level. There's a huge risk of optimizing on the meta-level at the cost of getting disconnected from reality. Instead of replacing the real work with meta discussions about processes, you should add metadata gathering into any process in such a way that the process itself is not disturbed. Then, on a regular basis, the agent does a focused reflection on this information. It sends feedback to you. This allows you to change course accordingly if needed.

Follow the flow

Now it is time to dive deeper into the practical application of our digital assistant. In this exercise, we start building a stronger digital experience. We want to find out what issues we have in our personal time handling, and what kind of interactions cause us to suffer most.

This way, we can look into the root cause of some observed negative impacts on our lives and find out how a simple digital agent could assist us.

In many of our daily tasks, we do not produce a final result on our own, but rather contribute to the success of collaborative work. Often, we deliver an artifact that crosses team boundaries. In other cases, we depend on the right input from others. Our own results can be heavily influenced by dependency on prompt contributions. In this way, others directly influence our success.

Work relationships between people are usually defined by organizational hierarchies. In too many cases, we observe a huge gap between the hierarchical structure and the real interaction structure. As a consequence, communication paths, information flow, and interaction paths are not well aligned. Starting on an individual level by looking into inbound and outbound interactions, we can build a foundation for optimizing our interaction patterns.

As an individual, I should be very clear about the things I'm supposed to deliver and the fence I'm supposed to deal with. This means being clear about the expectations others have of us by precisely defining roles and responsibilities are crucial to our success. On the other hand, I should be clear about the requirements others have before they can take over things I provide to them.

People define interfaces between teams, but they rarely define the exact criteria nor the process for validation of the items that are handed over. Handover routines usually lead to documents that are collected or digitally put into some tracking system. Real acceptance checks or feedback linked to rejections are not automated most of the time. As a consultant in the data industry, I saw a growing amount of information in many support data bases, but no targeted usage of all this wisdom happened. Why? Due to the lack of managing the information flow according to the intrinsic demand of the organization.

Most systems are document management systems, like archives. But information and knowledge must float around, it must change, grow, mix and get filtered. Most organizations simply ignore this and this is why I attempt to put this important digital skill onto your tool belt.

The lack of precise information flow and the lack of automated validation steps have a huge potential for losing time, customers, and money. Both can turn high-quality time into lower-value time. If you have planned to continue work on a certain task, but the prerequisites are not met and nobody has checked this beforehand, you are not able to deliver your valuable contribution. This drives people crazy, and this makes people angry. And here's a proposal of a solution:

Just start asking yourself before you hand over something to others: Has my result been rejected recently? Am I clear about the expectations of the other person? How would my contribution be validated before it can be used by the next person? Do I need a one on one conversation in order to clarify unsolved issues?

Start with this practice, as soon as possible! Other will follow you.

Besides the issues with your own deliverables, we find simple communication issues as a critical source of broken flows. People avoid asking for whatever reason, and this way they just delay the deliverable. One side is not aware of the real expectations, and without bad intentions but based on a lack of knowledge, they deliver the wrong thing, which again leads to delays and unnecessary rework. The solution is not in expecting others to know what we need when we have never told them, but rather in a very sharp reflection on an individual level. Everyone can ask himself if what is expected from him is in line with what he thinks and is capable of delivering.

In the case of any mismatch, it's time to adjust as soon as possible. This is exactly what intelligent systems can do; instead of just following predefined rules, they identify potential mismatches and adjust actions accordingly.

Instead of complaining about bad processes, we should turn the ship around and start by owning our handover activities.

Please remember that proper handover procedures must be well prepared - only then they can lead to a positive team experiences. In case people start complaining about the processes, something smells. This should be an indicator of bad alignment, information loss, gaps between expectations and capabilities.

Let's assume that people use their own agents and track incoming information, and also the outgoing information. Now think of adding status information related to their own personal availability and capability. Also, let's assume that this information can be analyzed and used for group-level reflections in an anonymous way. Leaders could apply a variety of consultation and optimization techniques related to handover procedures between individual people and across teams without all the emotional bias.

Putting automatic validation of preconditions and quality checks on deliverables in place can dramatically increase the throughput and the efficiency of human collaborative work.

Agents, if they are doing such kind of automated checks, can help leaders to see and recognize what can be improved much faster. Instead of just measuring the wrong metrics and instead of blaming people we can drive change and growth, for individuals and as also on a team level. Finally, the agent can offer learning paths and runbooks for improvement.

Ongoing improvements of human expertise will go hand in hand with this kind of change in interaction, as soon as such reflection agents are involved. More on this in the next part of this work.

Exercise 4: Optimizing Handover and Interaction Flows

This exercise helps you analyze your role in collaborative workflows, identify friction points in handovers, and implement strategies for smoother, more efficient interactions. By reflecting on dependencies and validation processes, you can minimize delays, improve communication, and ensure better alignment between expectations and deliverables.

Step 1: Assess Your Deliverables and Dependencies

Ask yourself:

- Is my output linked to others?
- Is my outcome linked to business value?
- Do I fully understand how my work contributes to the larger process?

Action: Identify the key people who rely on your work and those whose input you depend on. Create a simple diagram or list mapping these dependencies.

Step 2: Identify Bottlenecks and Negative Flows

- Am I a bottleneck in any process?
- Do others push back on the things I hand over to them?
- Have my results been rejected recently? If so, why?

Action: Review past cases where delays or rework occurred. Look for patterns—were certain expectations unclear? Were prerequisites unmet? Did lack of communication lead to misalignment?

Step 3: Strengthen the Handover Process

A well-structured handover should be a team experience, not just a

transfer of responsibility. Consider:

- Do I need a 1:1 conversation to clarify expectations before handing over my work?
- How would my contribution be validated before it can be used by the next person?
- Can I introduce a simple checklist or validation step before submission?

Action: Define or improve your personal handover routine to ensure smoother transitions. This could be as simple as implementing a final self-check before submission or scheduling a quick alignment meeting with the recipient.

Step 4: Implement Automated Checks with AI Agents

AI-driven agents can assist in tracking incoming and outgoing information, analyzing workflow patterns, and even automating validation checks. Consider how digital agents could:

- Provide a handover quality checklist before submission.
- Track dependencies and alert you when prerequisites are incomplete.
- Offer learning paths or process optimizations based on workflow insights.

Action: If applicable, explore how AI tools (such as workflow assistants or digital journals) can support smoother handovers by providing automated reminders, validation steps, or feedback loops.

Outcome

By improving your awareness of dependencies, strengthening communication, and refining your handover strategy, you create smarter, more efficient workflows. Instead of reacting to problems

after they occur, you take proactive ownership of your interactions—helping both yourself and your team work more effectively.

Conclusion

When implementing personal agents we must respect the boundaries around us. Others might not yet be interested in this new way of interacting with the world.

This means, in the beginning, we have to focus on our own environment first. We still can improve the way how we interact with our environment by putting automatic validation routines in place - this works for input provided by humans and by agents. Hence, by building active proxies which work in our name to support us and others we can drive this digital experience and steer it precisely into directions, where the risk is low, and the positive impact is high.

Another advantage of this approach is that we do not have to wait for others until the AI agents are rolled out in our organizations. It is on us to grow awareness and to improve our own digital expertise.

In the next chapter we step up one level. We look into group dynamics and collaboration with agents on a team level. We will look into this from a leader's perspective. This chapter gave us the foundation for effective adoption of agents on an individual level. Next we will create a positive group experience with agents involved.

Part 2: Digital Group Experience

Conservation of Knowledge (ASYNCH)

- I create my own PROXY to be more accessible by others
- Proxy vs. Avatar
- Example: OPI-BOT
- Outlook: Leader-Avatar

Co-Thinking:

- Combine digital artefacts and organize a continuous but asynchronous collaboration across distributed teams.
- avoid over-tracking and metrics-dictatorship
- NO nonsense KPIs
- pure inspiration by automatic correlation to the past (review and reflection of new ideas, auto aggregation and record-keeping)
- matching with inspirational references (collection of material)

Dilemma of Multi-Person-Workflows:

- What people think ...
- the downside of "SOPs"
- missing ownership

The emergine flow of actions:

- What people really do ...
- Workflow-Mapping in the age of agents

- extension to Skill Mapping
- do not copy workflows
- re-creation instead of rewriting and translation

Part 3: AI Driven Business

Managing Compliance and Risk

Attraction, Inspiration, and Fun

- the explorative bottom-up approach
- employee engagement via Part 1 activities
- team engagement via Part 2 activities

AI contribution and majority levels

- individual tasks are supported
- operations are supported / overseen (systematically)
- production is supported
- AI is an element of the service / products we deliver

Make - Buy - Rent:

- 6 dimensions of typical AI projects (a) relation to business (b) agent specifics (c) TECH stack (d) Data and Models (e) user adoption and engagement (f) Risk and compliance

Review & Conclusion

Outlook

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Next Steps

“RUNNING AGENTS” is an initiative to capture and share knowledge—both of which have been my priorities for a long time. Over the years, dozens of workshops with leaders from various industries have enriched my material collection. As the landscape continues to evolve, I want to respond to these changes in a meaningful way.

New opportunities arise almost every week, so let’s dive in! I’m looking for curious minds to join me on this journey. For my book project, I want to connect with people who have experience implementing agent-based systems or are actively exploring this field. Let’s shape the future together!

Appendix

AI Agent Glossary

20-terms you should know



@rakeshgohel01

1 Agent Autonomous entity that utilizes prompts and environment to perceive and to act on a goal.	2 Environment Context or sandbox where an AI agent operates and interacts with other tools.	3 Perception The AI Agents' ability to understand and interpret environmental data.	4 Action The current process performed by an AI agent, given a prompt or feedback by the user.
5 State The current condition of an agent's environment or system for a defined process.	6 LLMs Large language Models - the brain behind the Agents to think and perform their actions.	7 LRMs Large Reasoning model - a reasoning type for more context based reasoning for agents.	8 Tools Native or Third Party APIs used by Agents to perform their task outside of their environment.
9 Memory Storage for current context as well as past interactions between user and processes.	10 Knowledge Base Database for Agents' knowledge used to fuel and generate outcomes.	11 Orchestration Process of developing agents' interaction, starting from input, reasoning to output.	12 Planning The process of an AI agent determining a sequence of actions to achieve a goal.
13 Evaluation The assessment of an AI agent's performance, accuracy, in achieving its goals.	14 Architecture The blueprint of an AI agent, defining how its components interact and function.	15 CoT A reasoning technique where an agent breaks down complex problems into sequential steps.	16 ReACT A reasoning Framework for combining reasoning and acting iteratively.
17 Multi-Agent System (MAS) Multiple AI agents interacting in a shared space.	18 Swarm Agents that collectively exhibit intelligent behavior through self-organized interactions	19 Hand-offs The transfer of tasks or responsibilities between Multiple AI agents	20 Agent Debate AI agents engage in structured argumentation or discussion to create better outcomes

https://www.linkedin.com/posts/rakeshgohel01_if-youre-overwhelmed-by-new-ai-agent-releases-activity-7303059330830848001-iR4F?utm_source=share&utm_medium=member_desktop&rcm=ACoAAAlFw10B3TVAMFigUaZWSmyjCyS99-r5V5k

□ AI Agents are 10% AI and 90% Software, let me explain - https://www.linkedin.com/posts/rakeshgohel01_what-most-think-of-ai-agents-is-just-the-activity-7302335447534288899-pGx1?utm_source=share&utm_medium=member_desktop&rcm=ACoAADbIlqoBXsMJdD5Rmp0n6hdlqpbGIM-mkP4

THE 10 TENSIONS OF LEADERSHIP

By Justin Wright

Speaking Up

Speak when it matters, but make sure your team feels heard. Trust is built when voices are valued.

Listening

Empathy

Support your team, but don't lower expectations. Understanding challenges doesn't mean excusing performance.

Accountability

Power

Step in when needed, but give your team real responsibility. A culture of trust drives better results.

Empowerment

Vision

Inspire your team with a clear direction, then break it into practical steps they can execute.

Execution

Expertise

Share what you know, but invite fresh perspectives. Especially from those closest to the work.

Curiosity

Consistency

Be clear about what won't change, but stay agile when needed.

Adaptability

Instinct

Trust your intuition, but pressure-test it with facts. The best decisions come from both.

Data

Candor

Be direct without being harsh. People do their best work when they feel safe to learn and improve.

Compassion

Autonomy

Give your team room to solve problems their way, and step in when they need you. Trust grows both ways.

Support

Perfection

Ship, learn, refine. Sometimes "good enough to test" is exactly right.

Progress



Cassie Kozyrkov [in](#) · 1.

CEO, Google's first Chief Decision Scientist, AI Adviser, Decision St...
5 Tage · 🌐

Architecture

Agentic Mesh

<https://medium.com/data-science-collective/agentic-mesh-building-highly-reliable-agents-9a0d34277113>

MCP - the Assembler level

<https://www.anthropic.com/news/model-context-protocol>

camel-ai / owl

<https://t.co/0z7gCewjw5>

Oh, ja, das ist prima. Statt "LLM-APP mit MCP Client" haben wir nun einen "User-Agent" und statt platten MCP-Servern gibt es den Assistant Agent.

Seht gut diese Aufteilung. Der User-Agent ist für Personalisierung und hält auch Nutzersepezifische Besonderheiten für sich. Passt aber Resultate auch noch an und der Assistant Agent ist der Fachexperte, der weitere Fachexperten hinzu zieht.

Vertical vs. Horizontal Agent Services

2025 Horizontal & Vertical AI Agents

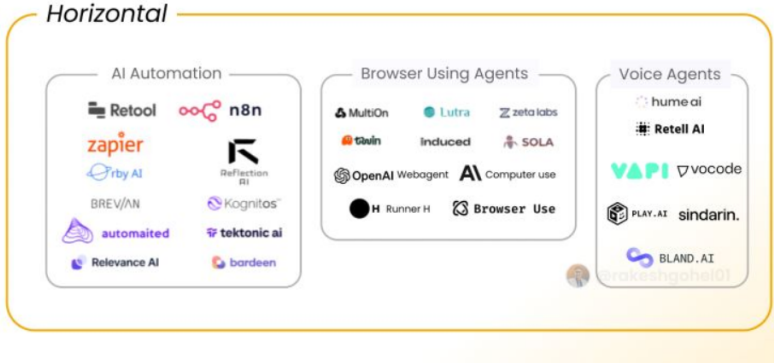
@rakeshgohel01

Vertical



AI Agents

Horizontal



How to run Agents?

The Runbook for Smart Leaders

This book provides you with a structured approach for taming the volatile environment of digital agents. You will be prepared for avoiding the tool trap. In case you are trapped already, the book will help you escaping the tool trap.

Being addicted to tools, because the tools are cool and intimidating, is a common problem in the digital age. The more tools we use, the more we are dependent on them. The more we are dependent on them, the more we are limited in our actions. The more we are limited in our actions, the more we are in danger of losing our human edge.

But there is a way out. This book will guide you through the process of adopting digital agents in a way that will enhance your leadership skills. You will learn how to leverage the power of AI agents while you strengthen your human edge.



Dr. Mirko Kämpf
maindset.ACADEMY

